

Open Up

Executive Summary

Clients

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Background

Open Up is a Pittsburgh-based nonprofit organization that expands access to wellbeing through inclusive movement and mindfulness education, with a particular focus on centering people with disabilities and building accessible community spaces. As the organization's programming and reporting needs have grown, Open Up has needed a more sustainable way to collect, organize, and report participant data without adding unnecessary administrative burden to its small staff.

Project Description

Project Opportunity

At the start of the project, Open Up's participant data workflow depended on several disconnected tools and manual processes. Registration information, attendance records, waiver responses, and demographic data were collected through different platforms, including Eventbrite, Google Forms, teacher surveys, and waiver forms. Staff then manually moved and organized this information across Google Sheets and MonkeyPod, Open Up's relationship-management system. This created several challenges: the process was time-consuming, vulnerable to inconsistencies, and difficult to use for grant reporting and organizational decision-making. Because demographic and attendance data are important for funding, impact reporting, and understanding who Open Up serves, the organization needed a more consistent and maintainable data system.

Project Vision

The consulting team's project focused on improving Open Up's waiver intake, participant data management, and reporting workflow. The original project direction explored a Google Forms and Google Sheets-based pipeline that would standardize waiver responses, validate required fields, flag records needing staff review, and prepare MonkeyPod-aligned outputs. After further investigation, the team found that Google Sheets imports could not update existing MonkeyPod relationships as effectively as needed. In response, the team revisited an earlier alternative: using Jotform for waiver collection because of its stronger integration with MonkeyPod. After discussing the cost and workflow tradeoffs with Open Up, the final solution shifted toward a Jotform-based waiver intake system, while keeping Google Sheets as a reporting and aggregation layer.

Project Outcomes

The final solution includes a digital Jotform waiver system, Google Sheets data infrastructure, aggregation and reporting tools, test cases, and system documentation. The Jotform waiver replaces Open Up's previous physical and Google Form waiver processes and includes conditional logic, required field validation, and mobile-friendly access for use on a studio iPad or personal device. The waiver also collects demographic information and newsletter preferences. Jotform responses are connected to a structured Google Sheets backend, where participant information can be organized, filtered, and used for grant reporting. The data is also connected to MonkeyPod, Open Up's CRM, and automatically creates new participant profiles and updates existing ones. The aggregation dashboard supports Open Up's grant and impact-reporting needs by combining waiver and attendance data, allowing staff to better understand who has submitted waivers, who has attended programming, and what demographic patterns appear across participants.

The project produced both technical and process outcomes. Technically, the team created an implementation-ready waiver intake workflow that connects Jotform, Google Sheets, and MonkeyPod in a way that better supports Open Up's existing operations. The solution reduces manual re-entry, improves consistency in participant records, and creates a clearer foundation for reporting. Procedurally, the team worked closely with Open Up to validate the workflow against staff needs, privacy concerns, participant complexity, and long-term maintainability. The project also clarified where full automation was not appropriate, especially in cases involving care-facility participants or participants without personal email addresses. To address this limitation, the team developed recommendations for creating and maintaining placeholder emails for dependent participants so that Open Up can reduce duplicate records while preserving flexibility in its intake process.

Project Deliverables

Our team provided a highly automated system for Open Up's waiver collection and data management. This includes a Jotform waiver and MonkeyPod attributes, which our team used to integrate a conditional waiver form based on participant types that automatically updates the CRM. It also includes the Google Sheets, which includes raw data from the waiver and studio sign-ins, transformed data, and dashboards to display analytics from this data.

In addition to our solution, we also provided validated test cases to showcase our system's capabilities and verify system reliability. We provided documentation for each part of the solution – MonkeyPod attributes, Jotform formatting and report functionalities, and Google Sheets functions. Together, these deliverables create a sustainable, scalable solution that drastically improves the data collection and analysis capabilities of Open Up.

Recommendations

The team recommends that Open Up continue maintaining the Jotform waiver logic carefully, regularly test the Jotform-to-MonkeyPod integration after major edits, create a secure placeholder email master sheet for care-facility participants, and use Jotform reports and Google Sheets dashboards for different reporting purposes. Jotform is best suited for waiver-only summaries, while the Google Sheets dashboard is better for attendance-based and date-range reporting. Future developers could build on this work by improving participant identification, creating more dedicated MonkeyPod fields for consent information, strengthening

name-matching in the dashboard, and exploring whether studio sign-in should eventually move from Google Forms to Jotform.

Student Consulting Team

Alicia Chen served as the technical lead for demographics- and Google Sheets related work. Alicia is a junior studying Information Systems and Computer Science. She is pursuing a career in software engineering, and will be in Seattle for a software engineering internship over the summer.

Adam Sultan served as the client communication and workflow design lead. Adam is a junior studying Information Systems and Human-Computer Interaction.. Adam is interested in pursuing software engineering, and will join PNC Financial Services this summer as a Software Engineering Intern.

Holly Wang served as the team's technical lead for MonkeyPod-related work. Holly is a senior majoring in Information Systems and Human-Computer Interaction, with a minor in Gender Studies. She is a Dietrich College Honors Fellow. After graduation, Holly will be pursuing a graduate degree in English Literature.